

Jordan Firth

Lieutenant Colonel, USSF
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Flight Test Engineer, 586 Flight Test Squadron

- Coordinated advanced avionics flight test and test support on highly-modified T-38B and C-12J aircraft, including operational test of JASSM-ER and final checkout of Iraq's first air-to-ground missile capability—Hellfires from a Cessna Caravan
- Developed squadron capability to deploy flares from T-38s

Rocket Sled Test Engineer, 846 Test Squadron

- Designed rocket sleds and sled profiles to test a variety of military programs, including munitions, aircrew safety, countermeasures
- Restored squadron capability to launch rail-captive Stinger missiles—used for operational test of CH-47 countermeasure system before fleet-wide deployment

Project Officer, Defense Support Program Operations

- Oversaw manufacturer contract support to DSP Operators, including anomaly resolution and routing training
- Updated Directorate leadership on state of DSP constellation

SBIRS System Test Engineer, Infrared Space Systems Directorate

- Oversaw system test of 3 space vehicles and Block 10 ground system upgrade
- Lead Editor and Co-Author of SBIRS Enterprise Test & Evaluation Master Plan, led DOT&E-level adjudication and review

Instructor, USAFA Department of Astronautics

- Course Director, Instructor for Astro 310: Introduction to Astronautics—led 5 instructors to deliver summer course
- Course Director, Instructor for Astro 321: Intermediate Astrodynamics
- Instructor for Engr Mech 320: Dynamics—collaborated with DFEM faculty to deliver foundational engineering course
- Led training for new department faculty—oversaw and critiqued first lectures, mentor throughout first year

Aerospace Engineering PhD student, NC State University

- Awarded \$180K NASA flight opportunity grant to develop boom rollable deployment technology
- Led 14-member research team to successful execution of two Zero-G parabolic test flights
- Oversaw upgrade of department test equipment (load frame) and introduced lab safety program

Instructor, AFIT liaison, AFROTC Det 595

- AFIT liaison for 8 active duty cadets pursuing AF-sponsored graduate degrees at NC State; built collaborative relationship between Detachment and AF-graduate team, including cadet mentorship and guest speaking in ROTC classes

- Led graduate team to cover classes for a semester when personnel moves and discipline issues reduced Detachment staff to one officer for 100+ cadets
- Course Director for AS 222: Team and Leadership Fundamentals II—prepared 27 students for field training

Branch Chief, DIA Office of Defense Technology and Long-Range Analysis

- Branch chief for 29 analysts at 7 sites providing acquisition intelligence support to DOD
- Rebuilt branch after COVID; tripled branch production for 2 consecutive years—went from practically no output to regular praise from SECDEF, Service Secretaries, and DASDs for ID'ing emerging threats
- Built and mentored strong team leads—led two of them to Directorate- and DIA-level FGO of the year
- Repaired office culture by building strong org-wide military-civilian cooperation and restoring trust in military leadership

Assistant Professor, USAFA Department of Astronautics

- FalconSAT research mentor for 3 semesters/13 students—led development of a cadet-built reaction wheel; reduced unwanted vibration, ID'd and fixed critical design flaws causing repeated failures of qualification-level vibe test
- Course Director for Astro 331: Space Systems Engineering; rewrote labs, lectures, homework; introduced extensive analysis/experimentation coursework
- Introduced collaboration/version control to 3 classes (and counting!)

Assessment Director, USAFA Department of Astronautics

- Performed mid-cycle accreditation review, restored assessments program after degradation due to evolving curricula